

Have fun with Vista's built-in games

If you reckon Windows games aren't worth playing, think again. Vista has some corkers

Windows has always come with a modest selection of built-in games, but these are often overlooked — mainly because, they've all been a bit basic. But if you haven't investigated Vista's complimentary collection of games yet, then you might be in for a pleasant surprise. Classics such as Solitaire and Minesweeper are still present, but they have been treated to 3D makeovers and are joined by some equally addictive additional titles, including Purple Place and Inkball. Vista Home Premium and Ultimate Editions boast nine games in total, including two premium games; Chess and Mahjong Titans. There's even the option to go online and download further puzzles and games — some for free. Here's our introduction to the frequently ignored fun side of Vista.

Tip 1

Before you begin playing, you may want to customise your games folder using the Vista's new Games Explorer window. Click the Start button, then in the right-hand Start Menu pane, click Games. From here, you can organise your settings and games and get useful information. Click on a



game, and the Community and Support menu includes access to a player community where you can get advice. There is also a link to the game's website which can be useful for retrieving any updates issued by the publisher. The Parental Controls let users set up individual accounts to control access, set time limits and block or allow games based on content, title or ratings system. If you want to customise one of Vista's built-in games, double-click on the icon in the Games Explorer, go to Game menu and select the Option